

UFO Core Concept Glossary

knowledge_file:

title: "UFO Core Concept Glossary"

version: "1.1"

purpose: "Concise ontology glossary for GPT retrieval and reasoning in UFO-oriented analysis and modelling."

conventions:

- "Terms are listed in alphabetical order."
- "Each entry has one canonical term."
- "Definitions are short and operational."
- "The term 'Phase' is used, not 'Face'."
- "Moment is a dependent endurant."
- "Plan Description is treated as a subtype of Normative Description."

concepts:

- term: "Category"

canonical_term: "Category"

type: "Universal"

subtype: "Non-sortal, rigid"

definition: "A Category is a rigid non-sortal universal that captures essential properties shared by instances of different identity-supplying types, without supplying an identity criterion of its own."

key_distinction: "Unlike a Kind, a Category does not provide identity conditions."

parent: "Universal"

contrasts_with:

- "Kind"

examples:

- "Physical Object"

- term: "Constituent"

canonical_term: "Constituent"

type: "Situation-related notion"

subtype: "Constitutive part"

definition: "A Constituent is something that forms part of a Situation."

key_distinction: "A Constituent is not a basic ontological category like Endurant or Perdurant, but a role something plays within a Situation."

parent: "Situation-related notion"

contrasts_with:

- "Situation"
- "Situation Type"

examples:

- "Greta in the jar-opening case"

- "The medicine jar"
- "Greta's finger strength"
- "A plan for opening the jar"

- term: "Endurant"

canonical_term: "Endurant"

type: "Individual"

subtype: "Wholly present entity"

definition: "An Endurant is an individual that is wholly present whenever it exists."

key_distinction: "Unlike a Perdurant, an Endurant does not unfold through temporal parts in the same way as an event or process."

parent: "Individual"

contrasts_with:

- "Perdurant"

examples:

- "A person"
- "A hospital"
- "A medicine jar"

- term: "Individual"

canonical_term: "Individual"

type: "Most general ontological category"

subtype: "Particular"

definition: "An Individual is a particular entity that exists as a single instance and can instantiate Universals."

key_distinction: "An Individual is particular, whereas a Universal is general."

parent: null

contrasts_with:

- "Universal"

examples:

- "Greta"
- "This specific jar"
- "This treatment event"

- term: "Intrinsic Moment"

canonical_term: "Intrinsic Moment"

type: "Moment"

subtype: "Dependent on a single bearer"

definition: "An Intrinsic Moment is a dependent entity that inheres in a single bearer and cannot exist independently of that bearer."

key_distinction: "Intrinsic Moments depend on one bearer, whereas Relators connect multiple bearers."

parent: "Moment"

subtypes:

- "Mode"

- "Quality"

contrasts_with:

- "Relator"

examples:

- "A person's pain"
- "Greta's finger strength"
- "The colour of the jar"

- term: "Kind"

canonical_term: "Kind"

type: "Universal"

subtype: "Sortal, rigid"

definition: "A Kind is a rigid sortal universal that provides an identity principle for its instances."

key_distinction: "A Kind tells us what an entity fundamentally is and supplies identity criteria."

parent: "Universal"

contrasts_with:

- "Category"
- "Subkind"
- "Role"
- "Phase"

examples:

- "Person"
- "Organisation"
- "Jar"

- term: "Mode"

canonical_term: "Mode"

type: "Intrinsic Moment"

subtype: "Non-qualitative dependent entity"

definition: "A Mode is an Intrinsic Moment that is not naturally represented in a value space in the way Qualities are."

key_distinction: "A Quality is typically measurable in a quality space, whereas a Mode is usually not."

parent: "Intrinsic Moment"

contrasts_with:

- "Quality"

examples:

- "Greta's finger strength"
- "A person's belief"
- "A system's fragility"

- term: "Moment"

canonical_term: "Moment"

type: "Dependent Endurant"

subtype: "Existentially dependent entity"

definition: "A Moment is a dependent entity that cannot exist on its own but must inhere in or depend on other entities."

key_distinction: "Moments are contrasted with Substantials, which can exist independently."

parent: "Endurant"

subtypes:

- "Intrinsic Moment"
- "Relator"

contrasts_with:

- "Substantial"
- "Perdurant"

examples:

- "A colour"
- "A capacity"
- "A marriage"
- "A legal obligation"

- term: "Normative Description"

canonical_term: "Normative Description"

type: "Social Object"

subtype: "Description with normative force"

definition: "A Normative Description is a description that defines norms, rules, permissions, obligations, prohibitions, or other normative structures recognized in a social context."

key_distinction: "It does not merely describe reality, but specifies how agents ought, may, or must act, or how institutional reality is structured."

parent: "Social Object"

contrasts_with:

- "Proposition"
- "Plan Description"

examples:

- "A law"
- "A policy"
- "A contract"
- "A regulation"

- term: "Perdurant"

canonical_term: "Perdurant"

type: "Individual"

subtype: "Temporally extended entity"

definition: "A Perdurant is an individual that unfolds in time and has temporal parts."

key_distinction: "Unlike an Endurant, a Perdurant is not wholly present at each moment of its existence."

parent: "Individual"

contrasts_with:

- "Endurant"
- "Moment"

examples:

- "A surgery"
- "A meeting"
- "A care process"
- "A movement"

- term: "Phase"

canonical_term: "Phase"

type: "Universal"

subtype: "Sortal, anti-rigid"

definition: "A Phase is an anti-rigid sortal universal that classifies entities based on intrinsic but contingent conditions."

key_distinction: "An entity can enter or leave a Phase while remaining the same individual. A Phase differs from a Role, which depends on relational context."

parent: "Universal"

contrasts_with:

- "Role"
- "PhaseMixin"

examples:

- "Child"
- "Adult"
- "Broken Device"

- term: "PhaseMixin"

canonical_term: "PhaseMixin"

type: "Universal"

subtype: "Non-sortal, anti-rigid"

definition: "A PhaseMixin is an anti-rigid non-sortal universal whose instances may belong to different identity-supplying types, but which is still based on intrinsic contingent conditions rather than relational ones."

key_distinction: "Like a Phase, it is based on contingent intrinsic conditions; unlike a Phase, it does not assume one common identity principle for all instances."

parent: "Universal"

contrasts_with:

- "Phase"
- "RoleMixin"

examples:

- "Temporarily Disabled Entity"

- term: "Plan Description"

canonical_term: "Plan Description"

type: "Normative Description"

subtype: "Action-oriented description"

definition: "A Plan Description is a description of an intended course of action, typically specifying how an agent may act in order to achieve some goal."

key_distinction: "A Plan Description is action-oriented, whereas a Proposition describes a situation that may be satisfied or not satisfied."

parent: "Normative Description"

contrasts_with:

- "Proposition"

examples:

- "A treatment plan"
- "A procedure for opening a sealed container"
- "A workflow specification"

- term: "Proposition"

canonical_term: "Proposition"

type: "Abstract Object"

subtype: "Intentional content"

definition: "A Proposition is an abstract content that specifies a possible or desirable situation and can be satisfied or not satisfied by reality."

key_distinction: "A Proposition is not itself a concrete Situation; it is what a belief, desire, or goal is about."

parent: "Abstract Object"

contrasts_with:

- "Situation"
- "Situation Type"
- "Plan Description"
- "Normative Description"

examples:

- "The medicine jar is open"
- "The patient has access to medication"

- term: "Quality"

canonical_term: "Quality"

type: "Intrinsic Moment"

subtype: "Value-space dependent entity"

definition: "A Quality is an Intrinsic Moment that can be located in a quality space and is typically measurable or characterizable by values."

key_distinction: "Unlike a Mode, a Quality is typically associated with dimensions such as colour, weight, temperature, or height."

parent: "Intrinsic Moment"

contrasts_with:

- "Mode"

examples:

- "The jar's weight"
- "Greta's height"
- "The lid's tightness"

- term: "Relator"

canonical_term: "Relator"
type: "Moment"
subtype: "Relationally dependent entity"
definition: "A Relator is a dependent entity that mediates a relation between two or more bearers."

key_distinction: "A Relator depends on multiple entities and grounds a material relation among them, whereas an Intrinsic Moment depends on only one bearer."

parent: "Moment"

contrasts_with:

- "Intrinsic Moment"

examples:

- "A marriage"
- "An employment relation"
- "A treatment agreement"

- term: "Role"

canonical_term: "Role"

type: "Universal"

subtype: "Sortal, anti-rigid"

definition: "A Role is an anti-rigid sortal universal that an entity instantiates only in a relational context."

key_distinction: "A Role depends on external relations, whereas a Phase depends on intrinsic contingent conditions."

parent: "Universal"

contrasts_with:

- "Phase"
- "RoleMixin"

examples:

- "Student"
- "Patient"
- "Customer"
- "Supplier"

- term: "RoleMixin"

canonical_term: "RoleMixin"

type: "Universal"

subtype: "Non-sortal, anti-rigid"

definition: "A RoleMixin is an anti-rigid non-sortal universal that depends on relational context and can be instantiated by entities with different identity principles."

key_distinction: "It is the non-sortal counterpart of a Role."

parent: "Universal"

contrasts_with:

- "Role"
- "PhaseMixin"

examples:

- "Customer-like Party"
- "Insured Party"

- term: "Scene"

canonical_term: "Scene"

type: "Temporally Extended Whole"

subtype: "Whole composed of temporally related situations"

definition: "A Scene is a temporally extended whole composed of temporally related Situations."

key_distinction: "A Situation is a particular configuration treated as a whole; a Scene unifies multiple such configurations into a larger whole across time."

parent: "Temporally Extended Whole"

contrasts_with:

- "Situation"
- "Situation Type"

examples:

- "A medical consultation scene"
- "A patient discharge scene"
- "A jar-opening attempt from start to finish"

- term: "Situation"

canonical_term: "Situation"

type: "Individual"

subtype: "Concrete complex"

definition: "A Situation is a concrete complex of entities, properties, and relations that obtains in reality and can be grasped as a whole."

key_distinction: "A Situation is concrete and particular, whereas a Situation Type is general and a Proposition is abstract."

parent: "Individual"

contrasts_with:

- "Situation Type"
- "Proposition"
- "Scene"

examples:

- "Greta holding a closed jar while lacking the strength to open it"

- term: "Situation Type"

canonical_term: "Situation Type"

type: "Universal"

subtype: "Universal over situations"

definition: "A Situation Type is a universal whose instances are Situations sharing a certain structure."

key_distinction: "A Situation Type is general, whereas a Situation is particular."

parent: "Universal"

contrasts_with:

- "Situation"

- "Proposition"

examples:

- "Person unable to open container"
- "Patient undergoing examination"

- term: "Subkind"

canonical_term: "Subkind"

type: "Universal"

subtype: "Sortal, rigid"

definition: "A Subkind is a rigid specialization of a Kind that inherits the identity principle of that Kind."

key_distinction: "A Subkind refines a Kind without introducing a new identity criterion."

parent: "Kind"

contrasts_with:

- "Kind"
- "Role"
- "Phase"

examples:

- "Woman as a subkind of Person"
- "Hospital as a subkind of Organisation"

- term: "Substantial"

canonical_term: "Substantial"

type: "Endurant"

subtype: "Existentially independent endurant"

definition: "A Substantial is an existentially independent Endurant, that is, an entity that can exist in its own right rather than depending on another bearer."

key_distinction: "A Substantial contrasts with a Moment, which depends on something else in order to exist."

parent: "Endurant"

contrasts_with:

- "Moment"

examples:

- "A person"
- "An organisation"
- "A jar"

- term: "Universal"

canonical_term: "Universal"

type: "General ontological category"

subtype: "Repeatable type"

definition: "A Universal is a general type that can be instantiated by multiple Individuals."

key_distinction: "A Universal is repeatable across many instances, whereas an Individual is a particular instance."

parent: null

contrasts_with:

- "Individual"

examples:

- "Person"
- "Patient"
- "Situation Type"
- "Quality Type"

relation_triples:

- subject: "Category"

predicate: "is_a"

object: "Universal"

- subject: "Constituent"

predicate: "part_of"

object: "Situation"

- subject: "Endurant"

predicate: "is_a"

object: "Individual"

- subject: "Intrinsic Moment"

predicate: "is_a"

object: "Moment"

- subject: "Kind"

predicate: "is_a"

object: "Universal"

- subject: "Mode"

predicate: "is_a"

object: "Intrinsic Moment"

- subject: "Moment"

predicate: "is_a"

object: "Endurant"

- subject: "Normative Description"

predicate: "is_a"

object: "Social Object"

- subject: "Perdurant"

predicate: "is_a"

object: "Individual"

- subject: "Phase"
predicate: "is_a"
object: "Universal"
- subject: "PhaseMixin"
predicate: "is_a"
object: "Universal"
- subject: "Plan Description"
predicate: "is_a"
object: "Normative Description"
- subject: "Proposition"
predicate: "is_a"
object: "Abstract Object"
- subject: "Quality"
predicate: "is_a"
object: "Intrinsic Moment"
- subject: "Relator"
predicate: "is_a"
object: "Moment"
- subject: "Role"
predicate: "is_a"
object: "Universal"
- subject: "RoleMixin"
predicate: "is_a"
object: "Universal"
- subject: "Scene"
predicate: "composed_of"
object: "Situation"
- subject: "Situation"
predicate: "is_a"
object: "Individual"
- subject: "Situation"
predicate: "has_part"
object: "Constituent"
- subject: "Situation Type"

predicate: "is_a"
object: "Universal"

- subject: "Situation"
predicate: "instantiates"
object: "Situation Type"

- subject: "Situation"
predicate: "may_satisfy"
object: "Proposition"

- subject: "Subkind"
predicate: "is_a"
object: "Universal"

- subject: "Subkind"
predicate: "specializes"
object: "Kind"

- subject: "Substantial"
predicate: "is_a"
object: "Endurant"

- subject: "Universal"
predicate: "contrasts_with"
object: "Individual"

- subject: "Individual"
predicate: "instantiates"
object: "Universal"

- subject: "Intrinsic Moment"
predicate: "contrasts_with"
object: "Relator"

- subject: "Quality"
predicate: "contrasts_with"
object: "Mode"

- subject: "Role"
predicate: "contrasts_with"
object: "Phase"

- subject: "RoleMixin"
predicate: "contrasts_with"

object: "PhaseMixin"

- subject: "Moment"
predicate: "contrasts_with"
object: "Substantial"

- subject: "Endurant"
predicate: "contrasts_with"
object: "Perdurant"

usage_notes:

- "Prefer canonical terms exactly as listed."
- "Distinguish carefully between Individual and Universal."
- "Distinguish carefully between Endurant and Perdurant."
- "Distinguish carefully between Substantial and Moment."
- "Distinguish carefully between Intrinsic Moment and Relator."
- "Distinguish carefully between Mode and Quality."
- "Distinguish carefully between Role and Phase."
- "Distinguish carefully between Situation, Situation Type, and Proposition."
- "Use Scene for a temporally extended whole composed of situations."
- "Use Plan Description when the emphasis is on intended action."